THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 7 · SET 01

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) Which of the following is one of the oldest mountain ranges of India?

(A) Himalaya (B) Siwalik (C) Aravalli (D) Purvanchal

> **Ans: (C)** The Aravalli range of Rajasthan is among the oldest fold mountains in the world; the Himalaya are young.

(ii) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.

Statement I: The Western Ghats are higher and more continuous than the Eastern Ghats.

Statement II: The Deccan Plateau lies between the Himalaya and the Northern Plains.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct

(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Statement II is wrong: the Deccan (Peninsular) Plateau lies south of the Northern Plains.

(iii) Which instrument is used to measure atmospheric (air) pressure?

(A) Barometer (B) Thermometer (C) Anemometer (D) Rain gauge

> **Ans: (A)** A barometer measures air pressure; an anemometer measures wind speed.

(iv) The Tropic of Cancer passes through how many Indian states?

(A) Five (B) Six (C) Ten (D) Eight

> **Ans: (D)** Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura and Mizoram.

(v) Which place in Meghalaya is known for receiving some of the highest rainfall in the world?

(A) Jaisalmer (B) Mawsynram (C) Shimla (D) Chennai

> **Ans: (B)** Moist monsoon winds are forced up the Khasi Hills at Mawsynram, giving very heavy rain.

(vi) Which of the Char Dham pilgrimage sites is located in the south of India?

(A) Badrinath (B) Rameswaram (C) Dwarka (D) Puri

> **Ans: (B)** Badrinath is in the north, Dwarka in the west, Puri in the east and Rameswaram in the south.

(vii) Which of the following mahajanapadas was governed as a republic (gana-sangha)?

(A) Magadha (B) Kosala (C) Avanti (D) Vajji

> **Ans: (D)** Vajji (with its capital at Vaishali) and Malla were republics ruled by assemblies.

(viii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Chandragupta Maurya becomes emperor
2. Alexander's army reaches the river Jhelum (Hydaspes) in Punjab
3. Ashoka's Kalinga war
4. Rise of the sixteen mahajanapadas

(A) 3, 1, 2, 4 (B) 1, 3, 2, 4 (C) 3, 2, 1, 4 (D) 3, 1, 4, 2

> **Ans: (A)** Correct order: mahajanapadas (c. 600 BCE) → Alexander in Punjab (326 BCE) → Chandragupta Maurya (321 BCE) → Kalinga war (c. 261 BCE).

(ix) Identify the correct match.

(A) Megasthenes – Arthashastra (B) Megasthenes – Meghaduta
(C) Megasthenes – Indica (D) Megasthenes – Harshacharita

> **Ans: (C)** Megasthenes, the Greek ambassador at Chandragupta's court, wrote the Indica.

(x) The Hathigumpha inscription describes the achievements of which king of Kalinga?

(A) Gautamiputra Satakarni (B) Kanishka
(C) Pushyamitra Shunga (D) Kharavela

> **Ans: (D)** It is carved in the Udayagiri hills near Bhubaneswar.

(xi) The Chinese monk who visited India during the rule of Chandragupta II was —

(A) Xuanzang (B) Megasthenes (C) Faxian (D) Marco Polo

> **Ans: (C)** Faxian travelled in India around the early 5th century CE and wrote about the Gupta empire.

(xii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.

Assertion (A): In a democracy the government is accountable to the people.
Reason (R): Citizens elect their representatives and can change them in the next election.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R explains A: because voters can remove representatives, governments must answer to them.

(xiii) The Constitution of India came into effect on —

(A) 15 August 1947 (B) 26 January 1950
(C) 26 November 1949 (D) 2 October 1950

> **Ans: (B)** It was adopted on 26 November 1949 and came into force on 26 January 1950 (Republic Day).

(xiv) Two traders find that one has wheat but wants cloth, while the other has cloth but wants salt. This shows the difficulty of the —

(A) double coincidence of wants in barter (B) divisibility of coins
(C) working of banks (D) use of digital payments

> **Ans: (A)** Barter works only when each person has what the other wants.

(xv) A trader who buys goods in large quantities from producers and sells them to retail shops is called a —

(A) wholesaler (B) consumer (C) farmer (D) retail customer

> **Ans: (A)** Wholesalers link producers with retailers.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Differentiate between weather and climate.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Weather: the day-to-day condition of the atmosphere (temperature, rain, wind, humidity) at a place — 1 mark
> - Climate: the average weather of a place over a long period (about 30 years or more) — 1 mark

OR

2.(B) Name any two elements of weather and the instrument used to measure each.

Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):

- Temperature — thermometer
- Atmospheric pressure — barometer
- Rainfall — rain gauge
- Wind speed — anemometer
- Humidity — hygrometer (any two pairs, 1 mark each)

3.(A) State any two features of the cities that grew up in the Second Urbanisation (c. 600 BCE).

Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):

- Located on river banks/trade routes of the Ganga plains
- Protected by walls/moats with gateways
- Craft production and trade; use of coins
- Rulers lived in the cities and collected taxes (any two, 1 mark each)

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3.(B) What were punch-marked coins? Why were they useful?

Marking points (1 + 1):

- Silver coins with symbols punched on them — 1 mark
- They made buying, selling and paying taxes easier than barter — 1 mark

4. State any two contributions of the Gupta period to science and mathematics.

Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):

- Aryabhata — explained that the Earth rotates on its axis; worked on the value of pi, and solved astronomy problems
- Decimal place-value system and use of zero spread
- Varahamihira wrote on astronomy, astrology and nature
- Iron pillar of Delhi shows advanced metallurgy (any two, 1 mark each)

5. State any two problems of the barter system.

Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):

- Need for a double coincidence of wants
- Difficulty in dividing goods (divisibility)
- Difficulty in carrying and storing goods (portability/durability)
- No common measure of value (any two, 1 mark each)

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three features of the administration under Chandragupta Maurya.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Capital at Pataliputra; the kingdom divided into provinces ruled by royal officers/princes
- Seven elements of the state (saptanga) as described in Kautilya's Arthashastra
- A large army and an organised system of spies
- Revenue from land and trade; tax officers collected it
- Megasthenes' Indica describes the city administration

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6.(B) How did Ashoka try to spread dhamma after the Kalinga war? Give any three ways.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- He gave up war and conquest after the suffering of Kalinga
- Edicts engraved on rocks and pillars in Brahmi and other scripts
- Appointed dhamma mahamattas to look after the welfare of people
- Built roads, wells, rest houses and hospitals; planted trees
- Sent messengers to other lands, including Sri Lanka

7.(A) Why is the Constitution called the supreme law of India? Give three points.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- All laws made by Parliament and states must follow it
- It states the fundamental rules by which the country is governed
- It lays down the rights and duties of citizens
- It divides powers between the Union, States and local bodies
- Any law against it can be struck down by the courts

OR

7.(B) State any three Fundamental Rights guaranteed by the Constitution of India.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Right to Equality
- Right to Freedom
- Right against Exploitation
- Right to Freedom of Religion
- Cultural and Educational Rights
- Right to Constitutional Remedies

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain any five factors that influence the climate of India.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Latitude — the Tropic of Cancer divides India; the south is hotter
- Altitude — temperature falls with height, so hills are cooler
- Distance from the sea — coasts have moderate climate; interior has extremes
- Relief — the Himalaya block cold winds and help trap monsoon rain
- Monsoon winds bring most of the annual rainfall
- Western disturbances bring winter rain to the north-west

OR

8.(B) Describe the four seasons of India with one feature of each.

Marking points (any four seasons with features; 1 mark each, 1 mark for neatness/completeness):

- Winter (December–February): cold, dry in the north
- Summer (March–May): hot; loo winds in the north-west
- Southwest monsoon (June–September): heavy rain
- Retreating monsoon (October–November): cloudy, humid, cyclones on east coast

9.(A) Explain the three organs of government — legislature, executive and judiciary — with one function of each.

Marking points:

- Legislature — makes laws (Parliament/State Legislatures); controls the budget (2 marks)
- Executive — carries out and enforces laws (President, PM, Council of Ministers, officials) (1.5 marks)
- Judiciary — interprets laws and settles disputes, protects rights (1.5 marks)

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9.(B) Trace the journey of a bag of wheat from a farmer to a consumer through the market chain. Mention any four steps and one cost involved.

> **Marking points (any four steps, 1 mark each; cost 1 mark):**
> - Farmer grows and sells to a trader/mandi
> - Wholesaler buys in bulk and stores in a warehouse
> - Wholesaler sells to flour mills/retailers
> - Retailer sells in small quantities
> - Consumer buys from the shop
> - Costs: transport, storage, packaging, labour

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The Kumbh Mela is held in rotation at four sacred places — Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain and Nashik — each at intervals of about twelve years. Crores of pilgrims, sadhus and families travel from every part of India to bathe in the sacred rivers and to listen to religious discourses. Local people, traders and volunteers work together to arrange food, shelter and safety.

(10.1) Name any two places where the Kumbh Mela is held.

> Any two of: Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain, Nashik.

(10.2) Why do pilgrims bathe in sacred rivers at the Mela?

> They believe it purifies them (spiritual cleansing) and brings merit.

(10.3) How do such pilgrimages help to build a sense of unity in India?

> (1) People from different regions, languages and communities meet and share a common tradition; (1) the sacred places spread across the country connect the whole land culturally/spiritually.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Mawsynram, in the Khasi Hills of Meghalaya, receives more than 11,000 mm of rain in a year. On the other hand, Jaisalmer in the Thar Desert of Rajasthan gets less than 200 mm. Both places are in India and both are affected by the monsoon winds, but they experience very different conditions.

(11.1) Which of the two places gets more rainfall?

> Mawsynram.

(11.2) Name the winds that bring most of the rain to India.

> The southwest monsoon winds.

(11.3) Give two reasons why the Thar Desert receives very little rain.

> Any two (1 mark each): the Aravalli range lies parallel to the monsoon branch and does not force the winds to rise; it is far from the moisture-bearing sea winds; hot, dry conditions and low relief that does not cause rain.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The Iron Pillar of Delhi, standing in the Qutb complex at Mehrauli, is about 7 metres tall. It was made more than 1,600 years ago, probably during the Gupta period, and has hardly rusted even though it has stood in the open all these years. An inscription on it praises a king named Chandra, often identified with Chandragupta II.

(12.1) Where is the Iron Pillar located?

> At Mehrauli, in Delhi (Qutb complex).

(12.2) Which Gupta king is associated with the inscription?

> Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya).

(12.3) What does the pillar tell us about the skills of Gupta-age craftspeople?

> (1) They had advanced knowledge of metallurgy (making and forging iron); (1) they could produce rust-resistant, high-quality iron in large pieces.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Radha buys vegetables for ₹ 120 at the weekly market. Instead of cash, she scans the shopkeeper's QR code on her phone and pays through UPI. The money moves at once from her bank account to the shopkeeper's account. The shopkeeper says that most of his customers now pay this way.

(13.1) Name the payment system used by Radha.

> UPI (Unified Payments Interface), a digital payment system.

(13.2) State one advantage of paying digitally.

> Quick; no need to carry cash; payments are recorded; safe (any one).

(13.3) How is this different from the barter system?

> (1) In barter goods are exchanged for goods and need a double coincidence of wants; (1) here money (in digital form) is the medium of exchange and can buy anything from anyone.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Pataliputra (Patna)
(II) Sanchi
(III) Prayagraj
(IV) Mawsynram
(V) Rameswaram
(VI) Ajmer

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Pataliputra located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Sanchi located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Prayagraj located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Mawsynram located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Rameswaram located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Ajmer located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Pataliputra (Patna) — **Bihar**
- (II) Sanchi — **Madhya Pradesh**
- (III) Prayagraj — **Uttar Pradesh**
- (IV) Mawsynram — **Meghalaya**
- (V) Rameswaram — **Tamil Nadu**
- (VI) Ajmer — **Rajasthan**

